



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Victoria DeLeo

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Wed, May 27, 2020 at 8:33 AM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Victoria DeLeo

Gender

Female

Nationality

US

Emailvdeleo@psu.edu**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

December 2020

City, state, and country of residence

State College, Pennsylvania, USA

University education

PhD | Plant Biology | the Pennsylvania State University | 2015-2020 (expected)
BS | Genetics, Applied Biotechnology | the University of Georgia | 2010-2014

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

My professional motivations are to understand the living world, to use that knowledge to protect natural systems and build more resilient agricultural systems, to share that knowledge in informal, non-intimidating ways with the public, and to build partnerships across national borders that enable each of these goals. Serving as a science fellow aligns with these motivations and would allow me to build on my experience sharing biological education with students while learning more about science and science education in another country.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

I took formal classes in science education and outreach during my PhD. As part of one class, I designed an activity for and participated in a local science night for elementary age children and their parents. More informally, I have been a volunteer since 2018 at the local science center, where I get to help children (~4-12yo) interact with the exhibits. Since 2018 I have helped run a plant ecology activity for high school students who are blind and visually impaired as part of the Summer Academy at PSU. I co-wrote the lesson plan. This summer I received a grant from the PSU arboretum to design and host an outreach activity using infrared and ultraviolet light to teach children about plant evolution. From an education perspective, I have wide-ranging experience teaching science to children outside of a classroom. From a cultural perspective, I have studied abroad in Italy, China, and the UK, and I spent the summer before my PhD at an internship in Taiwan. I can adjust to new ways of living and working, and I am sensitive to how differences in perspective can influence interactions with students and colleagues.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Doing science in industry
In science outreach
Other

If other, please specify.

science diplomacy or doing science for a non-profit

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

In the near term, I see myself in a postdoctoral or short term fellowship at a botanical garden, herbarium, museum, or arboretum, where I can do research and engage in science outreach. In the long term, I see myself at an internationally-focused non-profit, government agency, or private company working on conservation or agriculture and working with non-scientist stakeholders.

CV/Resumé

[DeLeoCVMay20_short.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Job board (Idealist, Indeed, etc.)
Other

If other, please specify.

worked in fellowships advising, and this came up in one of my searches for opportunities

Any extra comment or message.

I'm especially interested in the work done at Aavishkaar. I will be available to start after January 2021.

6/2/2020

Science-corps Mail - New Science Corps Fellow Application: Victoria DeLeo

Sent from Science Corps